



Employee relations and communications

Thriving organizations recognize the importance of harnessing people's ideas and energy to provide a competitive edge, while managers are eager to gain, retain, and build employee commitment and engagement.

How it works

Employee relations and communications are, either managed by human resources (HR) or as a function in their own right, are increasingly sophisticated. Rather than just relying on face-to-face talks and word of mouth, successful firms use added communication tools to help people understand the business goals and the individual's contribution to results. In particular,

leaders no longer send only one-way messages but harness a variety of interactive media, such as video- and tele-conferencing. Individuals and teams can use customized business social media, such as Yammer, to share ideas and knowledge, but may still choose to meet in formal settings such as councils and forums.

Communication in practice

In this example, a company is establishing weekly employee forums to facilitate communication and build trust throughout the business. To strengthen employee awareness, engagement, and commitment to the idea, various media are used, from email to webinars and discussion. Managers focus ever more on collaboration rather than just imparting information.

EMPLOYEE FORUMS

In many countries, employee communications used to focus on structured industrial relations, managed by HR. Employee relations are now based more on trust and building strong relationships. Many firms create formal works councils or employee forums.

At their best, employee forums:

- Allow representatives from across the business to share and generate ideas for improving performance.
- Encourage discussions on vision, changes, and plans for business.
- Recognize the value of employees.

Commitment

Engagement and involvement

Awareness and understanding

CONTACT

An email is sent to all employees with a short video informing them an employee forum is to be set up.



DEGREE OF COMMITMENT

TIME